

The Live SHOW

As guests reveal their deepest, darkest secrets in a trance, past life regression takes a new reality show to the top of the non-fiction charts

CLINICAL PSYCHOLOGIST TRUPTI JAYIN TAKES ACTOR MONICA BEDI THROUGH PAST LIFE REGRESSION



PAST TENSE

WHAT Past Life Regression therapy is a trance-like state where the subject can recall images from his or her past life.

The therapy claims to address people's fears by connecting them to their past life

HOW The therapist induces a semi-conscious state using either hypnosis or meditation; can last from 30 minutes to an hour.

WHO It is usually conducted by spiritual or reconnect guides, alternative healers and even by doctors.

BENEFITS Said to be beneficial in healing emotional or physical disorders that conventional medical practice has failed to.

COST Approximately Rs 1,000 to Rs 3,000 per session. Also depends on how well-known the practitioner is.

By Jhilmil Motihar and Nirmala Ravindran

Sitting on a super-sized cushion in his Bandra living room in the morning, Vikram Reddy is enjoying his few free hours. His diary is choc-a-block with three two-hour appointments daily and clients range from 18 to 65-year-olds but he's no business magnate. A clinical hypnotherapist, someone who helps people deal with problems in this life and more interestingly, in the past life, Reddy has gone from seeing one

patient a week to three in one day. And now thanks to a new show on NDTV Imagine, *Raaz Pichhle Janam Ka*, Past Life Regression (PLR), an alternative therapy that was discussed only in select circles, is suddenly dining table conversation. On air since December 7, it's the top-rated non-fiction show on TV currently, beating even the elimination episodes of *Bigg Boss*. The TRP for its opening week was 3.4, third only to *Rakhi ka Swayamvar* and *Bigg*

Boss 3. It seems it's hard to resist Bhojpuri actor-turned-melodramatic host Ravi Kishen, the boom box-voiced doctor, Trupti Jayin and the array of minor celebrities snuggling up in bed as she towers over them. But as much as it has engaged audiences, it has divided the medical community. Since the first episode when Swati Singh from Bhopal announced that she had died in an air crash, Dr Harish Shetty, a Mumbai psychiatrist, says "all my patients now want to undergo past life regression. I have to explain that it is